

provided for their daughter were an incentive for her to spend heavily on consumer goods. All the while she gave her business stepchild treatment.

Who do you think has more fears and worries—Ms. BPF or the typical unsubsidized affluent business owner? Logic might suggest that Ms. BPF should have no worries at all, since she receives intensive economic care from her parents. In fact, she has many more fears than do affluent men and women who receive no subsidies whatsoever.

Typical affluent business owners have only three major concerns (see [Table 3-4](#) in Chapter 3). All of these are related to the federal government. They fear policies and regulations that are unfavorable to business owners and the affluent population in general.

What does Ms. BPF fear? She told us that she had twelve major fears. How is it possible that a person who is almost completely insulated from financial risk has four times more fears than the typical affluent business owner? *Because these affluent business owners have overcome most of their fears. They have inoculated themselves from many fears by becoming completely self-sufficient.* And it was the very struggle to become economically self-sufficient that helped these business owners overcome them.

What are some of Ms. BPF's major fears and concerns? Remember, these are fears that are not paramount among the self-sustaining affluent population. Ms. BPF has substantial fear of the following:

- ◆ Her parents' estate being heavily taxed
- ◆ Experiencing a significant reduction in her standard of living
- ◆ Her business failing
- ◆ Not being wealthy enough to retire in comfort
- ◆ Being accused by her brothers and sisters of receiving more than her fair share of financial gifts and inheritance from their parents

Who is more confident, more content, more able to deal with adversity? It's not the Ms. BPFs of America. It's those who have been brought up by parents who rewarded independent thought and behavior. It's those who don't concern themselves with other people's money, who are more concerned about succeeding than about how much is in someone else's estate. Also, if one lives below one's means, one doesn't have to be concerned with the possibility of being forced to reduce one's